

"Facilitation 101"

Benefits of the Template

- How it helps the business owner: It helps the client (business owner) avoid slipping into immediate judgment or defensiveness by allowing them to process new ideas objectively through a third-person perspective. It also helps them safely visualize and map out complex challenges and solutions in their own business using highly structured, easy-to-understand visual models (such as contrast and ascension frameworks).
- How it helps the advisor: It allows the advisor to achieve a dominant hierarchical position early on, establishing credibility and seizing control of the meeting. It provides a repeatable structure to guide client creativity, navigate potential skepticism, build emotional connections ("theatre in their mind"), and successfully convert concepts into actionable client involvement.
- Who it may be suitable for: This material is ideal for advisors, consultants, or strategic facilitators who need to pitch new concepts, manage client resistance, and seamlessly transition clients from conceptual learning to practical application in their businesses.

How to Use the Material in Practice (Step-by-Step Method)

1. Frame the Conversation: Start the meeting by asking the client for feedback rather than telling them what to do. Use phrasing like, "I want to run a concept past you and get your feedback; if you like what you see, we'll explore how the concept relates to your business...". Conclude the framing with, "How does that sound?" to secure a psychological loop and gain their assumed agreement.
2. Lead with a 3rd Person Story: Introduce your concept using a fictional or third-person scenario (e.g., "Let's look at this through the eyes of Bill & Mary and their chocolate shop"). Keep your characters consistent to build familiarity and emotion, and effectively 'play both characters' to create context and disassociation so the client's neo-cortex engages without triggering emotional judgment.
3. Deploy a Conceptual Framework: As you explain the concept, use a framework to break the topic down from general to specific. Choose the right framework for your goal:
 - *Contrast Models*: Use these to compare the "Old World," "Current World," and "New World" to establish credibility and create disturbance.
 - *Ascension Models*: Use these ascending graphics to drive aspiration and motivation.
 - *Matrix Models*: Use these to highlight complex, decision-tree options (e.g., mapping influence vs. vocalness).
 - *Metaphor Models or Acronyms*: Use these to foster collaboration and create "sticky" intellectual property.

- *Common Problem Stories:* Use these to cover an issue (problem) which is already 'near and dear to their hearts'; Common Problem Stories are also one of the softest ways to allow you and the client to 'merge' and develop common ground.

4. Manage Skepticism and Gain Agreement: If your client appears skeptical or overly resistant to the concept, pause and gain agreement in principle based on the story. Ask, "So if we use Bill and Mary's case as a reference, would the concept be valid - in THEIR case?".

5. Secure Relevance: Wait for the client to actively participate in the context or show self-relevance (e.g., "That's like my business..."). If they try to jump in too early, politely 'park' their contributions until you finish explaining the concept.